

Sport & Fitness

47 words · Sport & Fitness

NOUNS

routine

a set of physical exercises done regularly

She has a morning routine of yoga and stretching.

stamina

the physical or mental energy to keep doing something for a long time

Marathon runners need incredible stamina.

match

an organised game between two players or teams

We're going to watch the match at the pub on Saturday.

spectator

a person who watches an event, especially a sports event, without taking part

There were over fifty thousand spectators at the stadium.

underdog

a competitor thought to have little chance of winning

Nobody expected the underdog to win, but they did.

pundit

an expert who gives their opinion on sport, especially on television or radio

The pundits all predicted a comfortable win, but they were wrong.

trainers

soft, comfortable shoes worn for sport or exercise (British English)

I really need new trainers. These ones are falling apart already.

fan

a person who strongly supports a team, sport, or player

She's a huge fan of the local football team.

cardio

exercise that raises your heart rate, such as running or cycling

I do half an hour of cardio before I lift weights.

nail-biter

a contest or match that is extremely close and tense until the very end

The final was a real nail-biter. It went all the way to penalties.

silverware

trophies awarded for winning a competition, especially in sport (British informal)

The team hasn't won any silverware in over a decade, but this season could finally be different.

ADJECTIVES

active

regularly doing physical exercise or movement

My grandad is still really active. He swims every day.

competitive

having a strong desire to win or be more successful than others

He's so competitive that he hates losing even at board games.

gutted

extremely disappointed (British informal)

We were absolutely gutted when we lost in the last minute.

gruelling

extremely tiring and demanding, requiring great effort

The coach put them through a gruelling three-hour session in the heat.

VERBS**jog**

to run at a slow, steady pace, especially for exercise

He jogs around the park every morning before work.

stretch

to extend your muscles to prepare for or recover from exercise

Always stretch before you run so you don't pull a muscle.

score

to get a point, goal, or run in a game

He scored twice in the first half.

beat

to defeat someone in a game or competition

They beat their rivals three-nil last weekend.

PHRASAL VERBS**warm up**

to prepare your body for exercise with gentle movement

We warmed up for ten minutes before the match started.

cool down

to do gentle exercise after intense activity to let your body recover

Make sure you cool down properly after a hard run, or you'll be stiff the next day.

cheer on

to shout encouragement to someone taking part in a race, game, or competition

Thousands of people lined the streets to cheer on the runners.

bulk up

to gain muscle and become physically bigger through training

He's been bulking up for the rugby season.

tone up

to make your muscles firmer and more defined through exercise

She joined a Pilates class to tone up before summer.

root for

to support and hope for the success of someone in a competition

Who are you rooting for in the final?

COLLOCATIONS**keep fit**

to maintain a good level of physical health through regular exercise

I cycle to work to keep fit.

personal best

the best result a person has ever achieved in a particular activity

She set a new personal best in the 10k this weekend.

armchair fan

someone who follows a sport closely but only ever watches it on television

He calls himself an expert, but he's just an armchair fan. He's never even been to a match.

training partner

a person you exercise or practise a sport with regularly

Having a training partner keeps me motivated to actually show up.

lose momentum

to gradually stop making progress or effort in something

I lost all my momentum after missing two weeks of training with a cold.

endorsement deal

an agreement in which a company pays a well-known athlete to promote its products

The tennis star signed a multi-million-pound endorsement deal with a sportswear brand.

photo finish

a race so close the winner can only be told from a photograph

Unbelievable, it came down to a photo finish. I've never seen anything like it.

sell-out crowd

an audience that fills every available seat, having bought all the tickets

The stadium had a sell-out crowd of over eighty thousand for the final.

IDIOMS

couch potato

a person who spends a lot of time sitting and watching television instead of being active

Since he started working from home, he's turned into a total couch potato.

shed a few pounds

to lose a small amount of body weight

He's been running every morning to shed a few pounds before the wedding.

have two left feet

to be very clumsy or awkward, especially at sport or dancing

I'd love to join the football team, but I have two left feet.

hit a plateau

to reach a point where progress stops, despite continued effort

After the first month, my weight loss hit a plateau and nothing seemed to shift it.

hit the gym

to go and exercise, especially with weights or machines

I try to hit the gym three times a week.

neck and neck

very close in a race or competition, with neither side clearly ahead

The two runners were neck and neck for most of the race.

household name

someone or something so famous that almost everyone recognises it

After winning gold at the Olympics, she became a household name overnight.

raise your game

to improve your performance, especially when it matters most

The manager told the players they needed to raise their game if they wanted to reach the final.

SET PHRASES

go for a run

to go outside and run, usually for exercise

I usually go for a run before breakfast.

turn professional

to start being paid to compete in a sport, rather than playing as an amateur

He turned professional at just seventeen and never looked back.

can't be bothered

lacking the energy or motivation to do something

Honestly, I can't be bothered today, maybe tomorrow?

against all odds

despite there being very little chance of success

Against all odds, the smallest team in the league won the championship.

MODERN SLANG

gym rat

a person who spends a huge amount of time training at the gym

He's such a gym rat that he's there before work, at lunch, and after too.

make gains

to build noticeable muscle or strength through training (gym slang)

He's been so consistent that you can really see him making gains.